

Blackwood If you have an agreed suit, you can find out how many Aces (and Kings) partner holds by using a 4NT bid. A reply of 5♣ shows 0 or 4, 5♦ shows 1, 5♥ shows 2 and 5♠ shows 3.

If your side has all four Aces, bidding 5NT will repeat the process for Kings.

The Replier can show one Ace plus a Void by bidding 6 of the Void suit if it ranks below the agreed trump, or 6 of the trump suit if the Void ranks above.

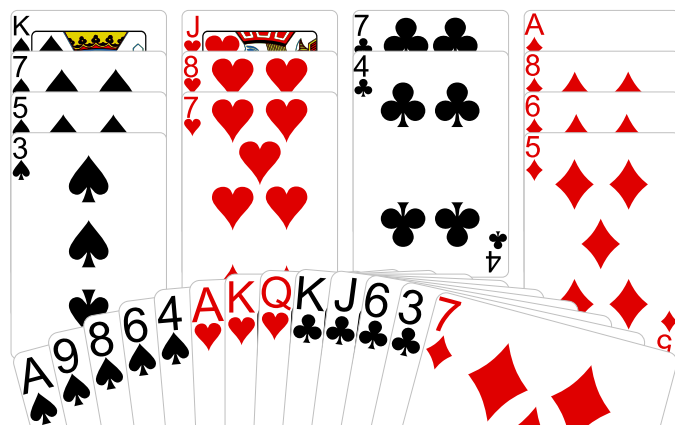
A Reply of 5NT shows two Aces plus a Void in some suit.

Gerber : Similar to Blackwood, this convention uses a 4♣ bid to initiate the Ace question, with 4♦ showing 0 or 4, 4♥ showing 1, 4♠ showing 2 and 4NT showing 3.

Not all 4♣ bids are Gerber, and deciding which ones are needs to be addressed by the partnership. For these Deals 4♣ is Gerber only when it follows a bid of 1NT or 2NT.

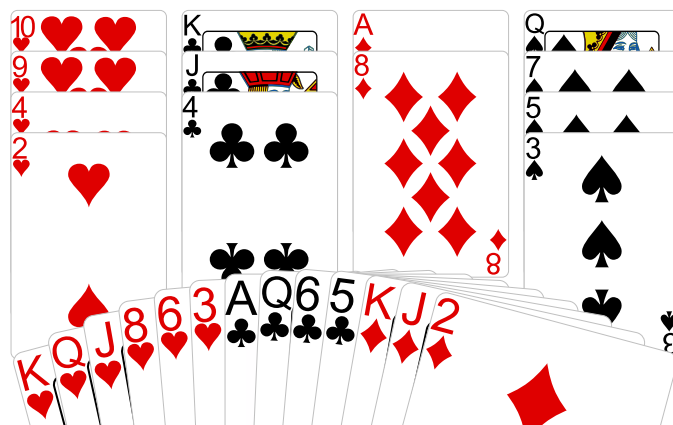
BakerBridge has complete lessons for these two conventions.

Deal 1 Ctr: 4♠ Goal: at most ____ losers



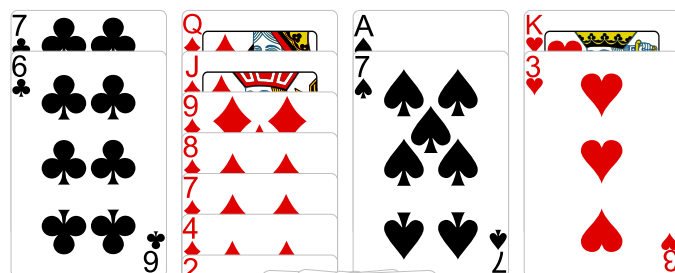
Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Deal 2 Ctr: 6♥ Goal: at most ____ losers



Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Deal 3 Ctr: 7NT Goal: at least ____ winners



Count Sure Winners				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Develop Winners				
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play	

Deal 4 Ctr: 4NT Goal: at least ____ winners



Count Sure Winners				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Develop Winners				
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play	

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: North

Board: 2

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 6♥

Declarer: East

Board: 3

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 7NT

Declarer: South

Board: 4

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 4NT

Declarer: West

Board: 5

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4NT

Declarer: North

Deal 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q
♥ T 6
♦ T 9 4 3 2
♣ A Q T 9 8

17
8 7
8

♠ A 9 8 6 4

♥ A K Q

♦ 7

♣ K J 6 3



♠ K 7 5 3

♥ J 8 7

♦ A 8 6 5

♣ 7 4

♠ J T 2
♥ 9 5 4 3 2
♦ K Q J
♣ 5 2

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NORTH may have a good hand but SOUTH merely gave a simple raise.

Even if SOUTH has a maximum there won't be a slam.

West	North	East	South
	1 ♠		2 ♠
Pass	4 ♠		
All Pass			
4 ♠ by North			

Deal 2

East Deals
N-S Vul

♠ Q 7 5 3
♥ T 9 4 2
♦ A 8
♣ K J 4

6
10 16
8

♠ K J 8 4 2
♥ 5
♦ Q 6 5 4
♣ 9 8 7



♠ A T 9 6
♥ A 7
♦ T 9 7 3
♣ T 3 2

♠ -
♥ K Q J 8 6 3
♦ K J 2
♣ A Q 6 5

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EAST has a tough decision after the two Control-showing bids.

If he uses Blackwood and WEST shows two Aces he will be no better off, because he won't know if one

of the Aces is the useless ♠A. Based on knowing that WEST holds the

♦

West

North

East

South

A,

3♥

Pass

1♥

Pass

he bids 6

4♦

Pass

4♣

Pass

♥

All Pass

6♥

6♥ by East

, hoping that he can at least make that and that 7 isn't a laydown!

Deal 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q J 9 8 5

♥ J 7 6 4

♦ T

♣ T 3 2

10

4 5

21

♠ A 7

♥ K 3

♦ Q J 9 8 7 4 2

♣ 7 6



♠ K 6 2

♥ A T 9

♦ A K 3

♣ A K 8 4

♠ T 4 3

♥ Q 8 5 2

♦ 6 5

♣ Q J 9 5

West

North

East

South

Pass

4♣

Pass

4NT

Pass

5♣

Pass

5NT

Pass

7NT

All Pass

7NT by South

slam and bids 7NT.

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NORTH isn't sure just how much he can make,
but surely 6

♦

isn't

too much to hope for.

He starts with a Gerber 4♣ and SOUTH shows
three Aces.Hmmm, 5♣ asks for Kings and SOUTH shows
three.Hmm, NORTH can now count all thirteen
tricks, so he forgets about the

♦

Deal 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A K Q
 ♥ K Q 6
 ♦ K Q 3
 ♣ J 8 7 5

5
 20 11
 4

♠ T 9 7

♥ A T 8 5 4

♦ J 7 6

♣ 4 2



♠ 6 5 4 3 2

♥ 9 3

♦ A T 9 4 2

♣ 3

♠ J 8

♥ J 7 2

♦ 8 5

♣ A K Q T 9 6

West

2NT

4♥

All Pass

4NT by West

North

Pass

Pass

East

4♣

4NT

South

Pass

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EAST has 13 points and can contribute six tricks so she figures that twelve tricks will be a slam (dunk).

However, just to make sure the opponents don't take the first two tricks she checks with Gerber.

Uh Oh, missing two Aces she signs off at 4NT. She could also happily play 5♣, but it

would be tricky to get there. Very tricky.

Deal 5

North Deals
None Vul

♠ 8 3 2
♥ 5 4
♦ Q T 7 2
♣ J 9 8 4

15
3 7
15

♠ K 7 5
♥ Q 9 6
♦ A 9 8 3
♣ A Q 7



♠ A Q 6
♥ K 7 3
♦ K 6
♣ K T 6 5 3

♠ J T 9 4
♥ A J T 8 2
♦ J 5 4
♣ 2

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	4NT

All Pass

4NT by North
declines the invitation. If her



Q

were changed to the



As she would bid 6NT and collect her twelve easy tricks.

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Yes, this has nothing to do with Gerber or Blackwood, but everything to do with smart bidding.

SOUTH has a 16 points and NORTH has 15, 16 or 17. SOUTH wants to be in 6NT if NORTH has 17,

but merely a Notrump game if she has 15 or 16.

The way to find out is to bid 4NT - not Blackwood but merely an invitation to bid 6NT.

In this case, NORTH has but 15 points and